



Using SGS ZOOM accounts

2025-09-08

Background

ZOOM has become an everyday feature of life in Shambhala. We are usually only aware of our own individual uses, not how Zoom is used more broadly. In SGS Zoom is used to offer classes, to host small- and large-scale gatherings, and for administrative functions of all kinds. SGS Zoom accounts are used by SGS staff, Shambhala Online, the Shambhala Board, and other groups such as the Code of Conduct officers and the Global Community Council. We have an educational license, which makes Zoom affordable.

Recently, detailed records of each meeting or event held on Zoom since June 2024 have become available. Those records detail the meeting’s host, the number of participants, the event date, whether it was recorded, and its duration. All of this data can be summarized by month to get a sense of the level of activity and trends over time.

Big Events in Shambhala

Although only one fourth of the events using Shambhala Zoom accounts have more than 5 participants, Zoom hosts some events that draw more than the 300 limit that applies to our standard accounts.

Events with more than 300 participants		
Since 2024-06-01		
Title	Participants	Date
2024 Continuing Education for Meditation Instructors: Week-end Three	434	2024-06-23
Drala	327	2025-01-11
Drala	305	2025-01-12
The Funeral Ceremony of Lady Diana Judith Mukpo	686	2025-09-17
The Funeral Ceremony of Lady Diana Judith Mukpo	568	2025-09-17



Daytime for Shambhala

Here are the busy-times for Shambhala:

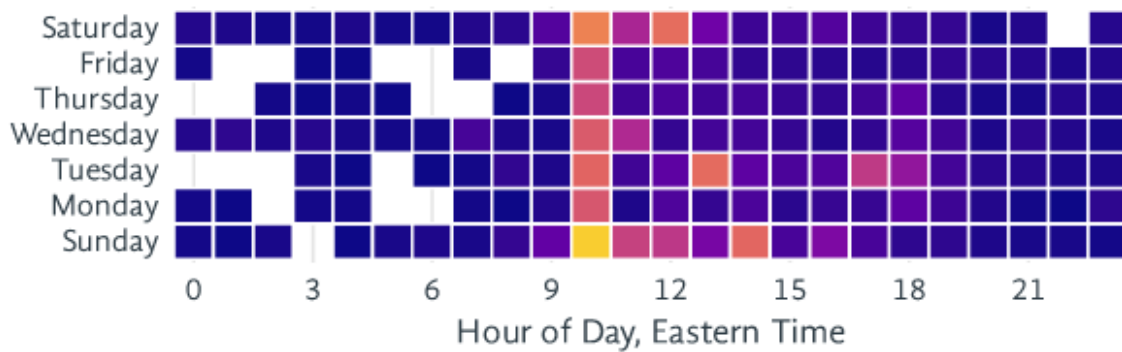
Shambhala's Zoom Events

All events between Jun 2024 and Sep 2025

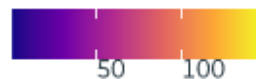
Other Zoom Accounts



Shambhala Online



Number of
Events



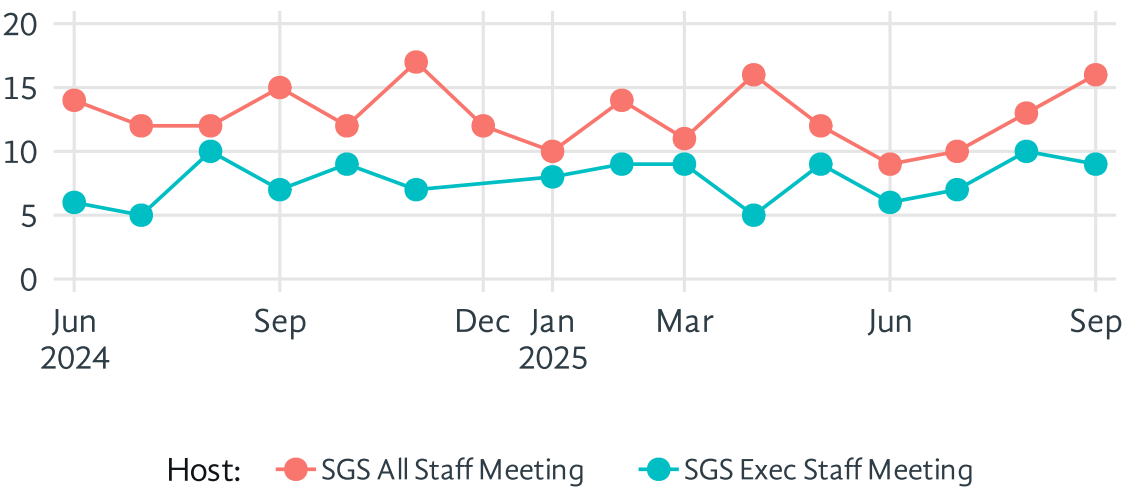


Scale of ZOOM use

Regular staff meetings are the core of SGS administration. (In the following graph, the yellow line represents January 1, 2025.)

Participation in SGS Staff meetings

Half of 2024 through August of 2025

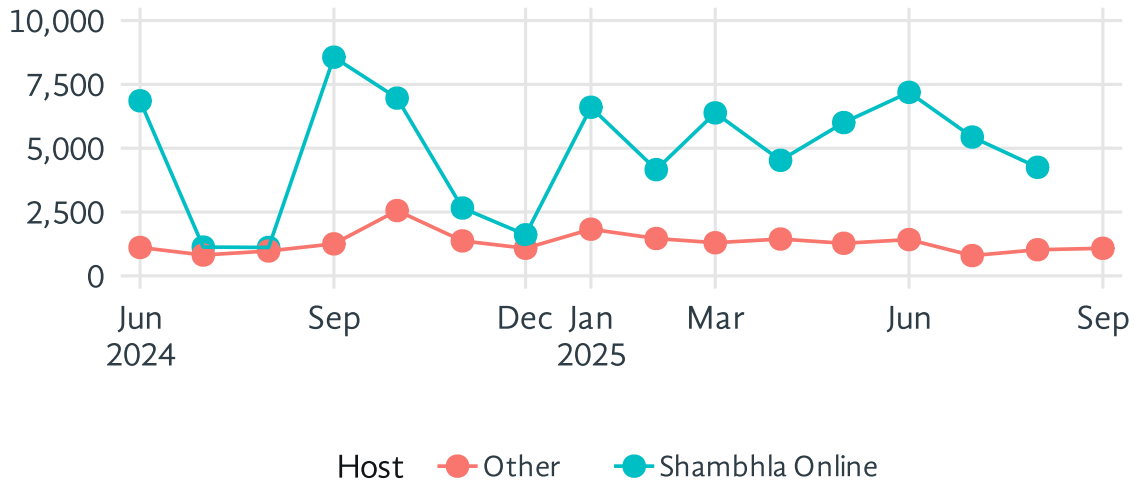


To get a sense of the scale of SGS use, look at the length of zoom meetings (in hours) multiplied by the number of participants. The data doesn't distinguish between internal use within SGS and the hours that our community as a whole spends on ZOOM in events hosted by SGS.



Monthly Hours on ZOOM

Half of 2024 through August of 2025



Some ways of visualizing 10,000 hours in **one month's** use of ZOOM could be:

- Over 13 months of continuous Zoom video conference calls
- The energy consumption equivalent to driving an average car approximately 25,000-50,000 miles (2 to years average in the US).

Total video activity in Shambhala is greater than this, since many Zoom recordings are shared after the fact via Vimeo or other storage locations such as Google Drive.

Recordings

In addition to all the other functions that Zoom offers, recording a meeting to ZOOM's cloud storage is convenient and enables a meeting or class to be reviewed, sharing it with others who missed it live, or for transfer and distribution via Vimeo, in the case of Shambhala Online.

Only 10% of the total zoom meetings between June 2024 and the present were recorded. We pay extra for Zoom recordings that we leave in the cloud for too long. In the 2nd quarter of 2025, SGS paid about \$350 for cloud storage overages.

Scale Differences in the Use of Recordings

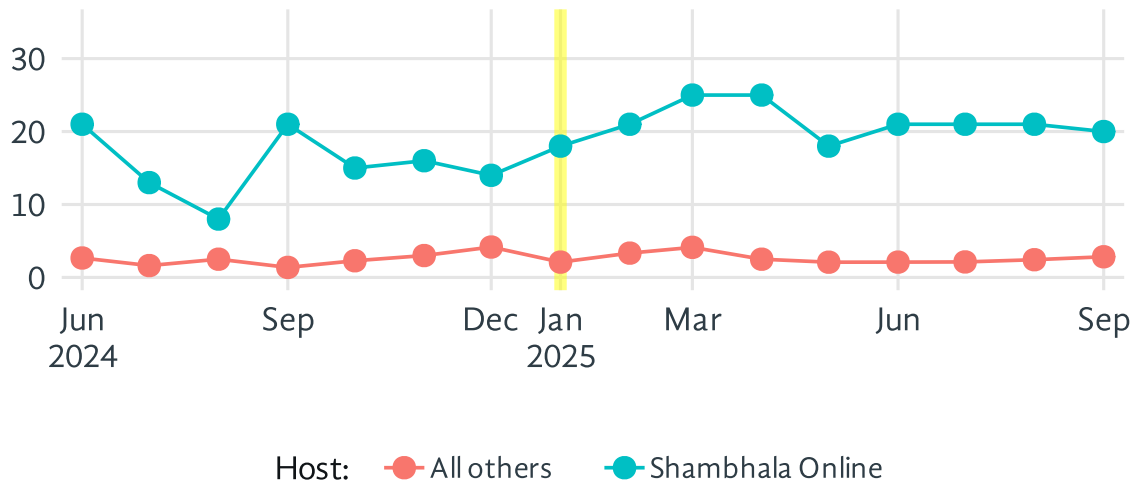
Shambhala Online operates at a much different scale than the rest of SGS in its use of Zoom and the functions of recordings. Shambhala Online has 9 different accounts that are used together and somewhat interchangeably. To show this difference in scale, the following graphs **add up** Shambhala Online activity (where different accounts share an overall function) and contrast it with the individual **averages** of other SGS Zoom accounts (which have distinct functions and are generally not instructional).



In these two graphs, Shambhala Online **totals** are contrasted with **averages** for individual accounts.

Number of Recorded Events

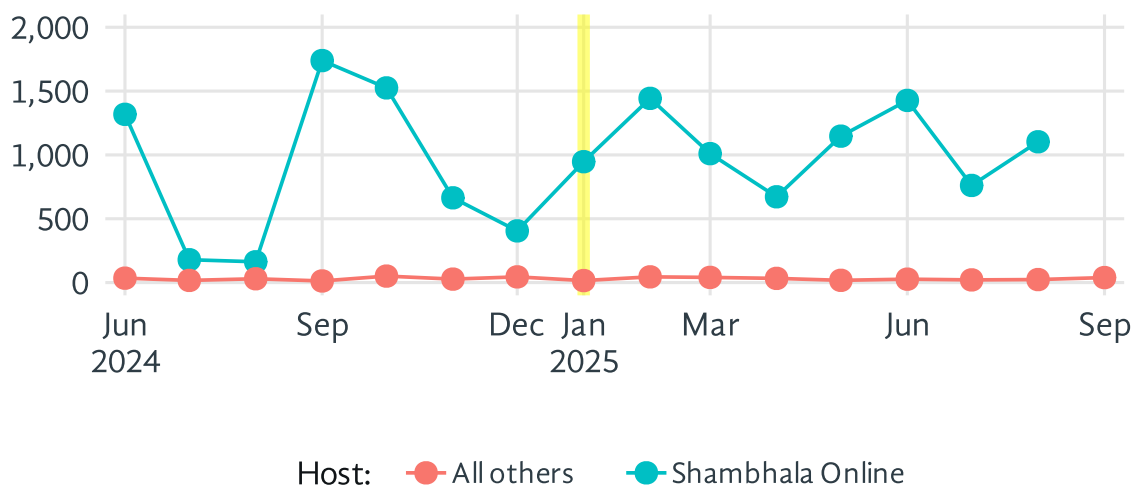
Half of 2024 through August of 2025



Not only are there **more** Shambhala Online events, those events have more participants.

Participants in Recorded Events

Half of 2024 through August of 2025



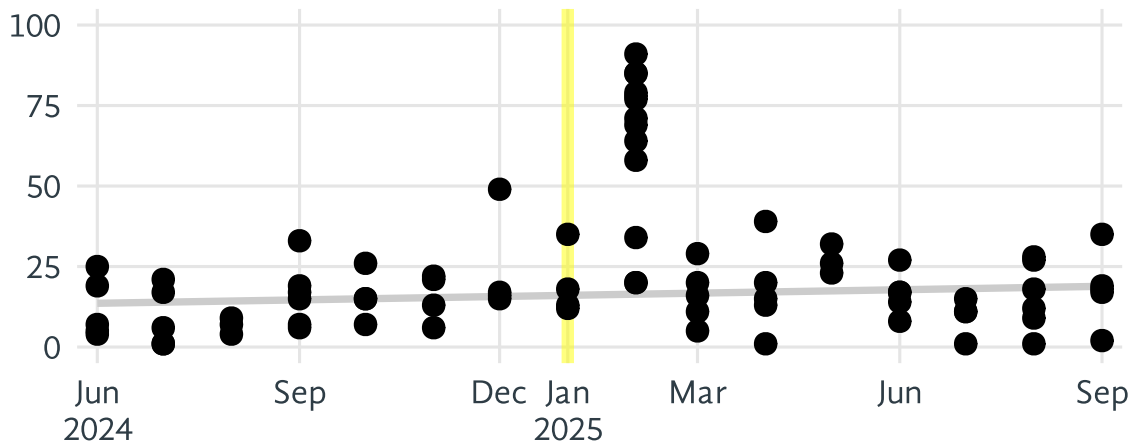


Participation in Recorded Regularly Scheduled Online Offerings

Regularly-scheduled gatherings presented by Shambhala Online and SGS departments let us see activity trends.

Participation in Sunday Gatherings

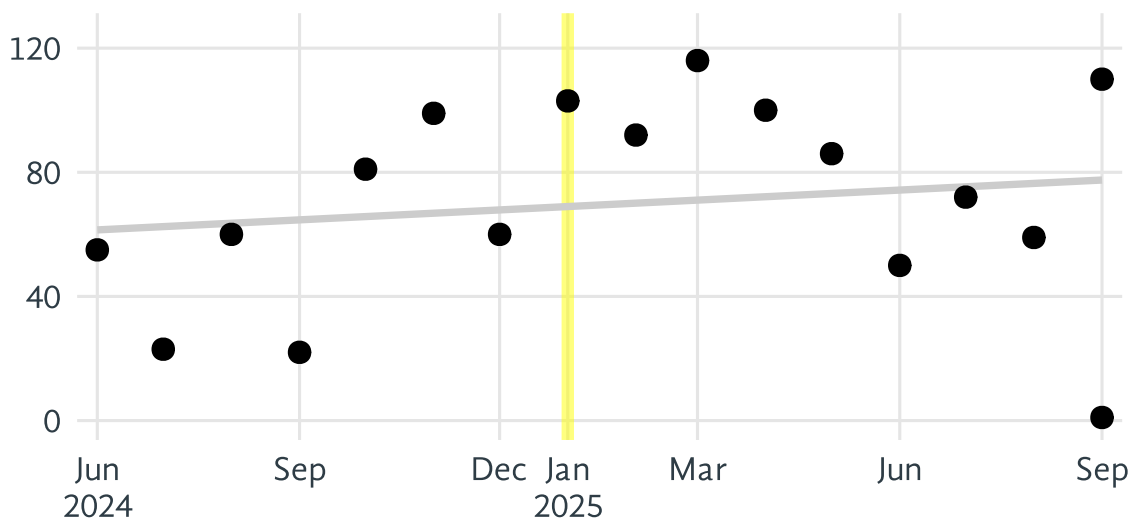
Half of 2024 through August of 2025



Mamo chants drew many people in February 2024

Leadership Forums

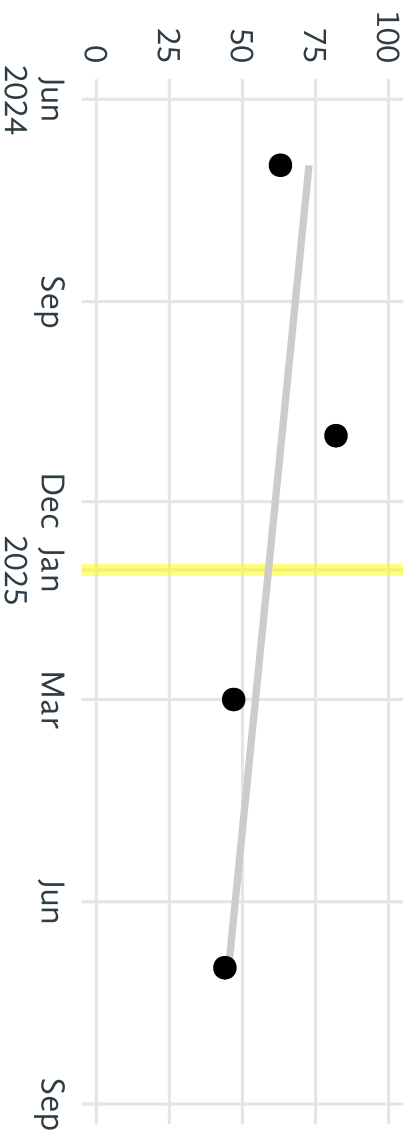
Half of 2024 through August of 2025





P&E Leadership Calls

Half of 2024 through August of 2025



Three or four P&E calls at different times are offered each quarter.
Here the number of participants are added up.

There are many other regular events, such as staff meetings, that are core activities but are not regularly recorded.



Daily Tonglen Practice

The Compassion for Ukraine - Daily Tonglen sessions represent an extraordinary example of community dedication and consistency.

Timing Patterns

Key Statistics

- **Total sessions:** 555
- **Daily coverage:** 100% (sessions on 487 of 487 days)
- **Average participants:** 14.5
- **Average duration:** 75.5 minutes

Daily Tonglen Participation Over Time

June 2024 - September 2025

